



SPLASH & DASH AUTO DETAIL CENTER

St. Thomas, U.S. Virgin Islands

COMPOUND • POLISH • PAINT CORRECTION SERVICE GUIDE

Professional Paint Refinement • Gloss Enhancement • Defect Reduction

QUALITY-FIRST PAINT CORRECTION

Paint correction is the controlled process of leveling and refining the upper surface of automotive paint to reduce visible defects and restore clarity, gloss, depth, and reflectivity. Depending on the condition of the vehicle, this may involve compounding, polishing, or a combination of both.

Our goal is not simply to remove as many scratches as possible. The goal is to achieve the best visual improvement while safely preserving as much healthy clear coat as possible.

PRICING DISCLAIMER: All prices are starting prices and are subject to vehicle inspection, paint condition, paint hardness, defect severity, vehicle size, panel accessibility, previous repairs, coating/film history, and the amount of labor required. Final pricing is confirmed after inspection.

1. COMPOUNDING VS. POLISHING

Service	Purpose	Typical Result
Paint Enhancement / One-Step Polish	Refines light defects while prioritizing gloss and finish safety.	Improved gloss, clarity and reduction of light swirls/haze.
One-Step Compound + Polish	Uses a cutting step followed by refinement when appropriate.	Stronger defect reduction with a refined finish.
Stage 1 Correction	Moderate machine correction focused on common wash marks and oxidation.	Approx. 50–70% visible defect reduction when paint condition allows.
Stage 2 Correction	More aggressive multi-step correction with additional refinement.	Approx. 80–90% visible defect reduction when paint condition allows.
Heavy / Custom Correction	Multiple cutting and finishing steps for severe defects.	Maximum practical correction determined by paint condition and safe clear-coat limits.

2. STARTING PRICING

Vehicle Type	One-Step / Enhancement	Stage 1	Stage 2
2-Door Coupe	\$300	\$450–\$650	\$800–\$1,100

Vehicle Type	One-Step / Enhancement	Stage 1	Stage 2
Small Sedan	\$350	\$500–\$700	\$850–\$1,200
Large Sedan	\$400	\$550–\$750	\$950–\$1,300
Small SUV / Crossover	\$400	\$600–\$800	\$1,000–\$1,400
Mid-Size SUV	\$450	\$650–\$850	\$1,100–\$1,500
Large SUV	\$500	\$700–\$950	\$1,200–\$1,700
Small Pickup	\$450	\$600–\$850	\$1,050–\$1,450
Mid-Size Pickup	\$500	\$650–\$900	\$1,100–\$1,550
Full-Size Pickup	\$550	\$700–\$950	\$1,200–\$1,700
Large Truck / SUV	\$600+	\$800+	\$1,400+
Van / Commercial	\$650+	\$900+	\$1,600+

3. WHAT PAINT CORRECTION CAN HELP WITH

- Swirl marks and wash-induced micro-marring
- Light to moderate scratches that have not penetrated deeply into the paint system
- Oxidation and dullness
- Light water spotting and mineral staining
- Haze and light sanding marks when appropriate
- Fine scuffing and light surface defects
- Loss of gloss and paint clarity
- Uneven visual finish from improper washing or previous polishing
- Restoration of depth, reflection and overall paint appearance

KEY BENEFITS

- Restores gloss and paint clarity
- Improves reflection and color depth
- Reduces the appearance of swirls and fine scratches
- Removes oxidation and surface haze when safely correctable
- Creates a cleaner, smoother surface for waxes, sealants or ceramic coatings
- Can significantly improve the appearance of older paint without repainting when the paint is still healthy enough for correction

4. PAINT INSPECTION — WHY IT MATTERS

Every vehicle should be inspected before correction. Paint correction removes microscopic amounts of material from the surface, so the condition and thickness of the paint system determine how aggressive we can safely be.

Inspection Area	What We Look For
Clear Coat Health	Peeling, cracking, delamination, oxidation, thin areas and signs of clear-coat failure.
Scratch Depth	Whether a defect is safely correctable or has penetrated too deeply into the clear coat or paint.
Paint Thickness	Available material and whether aggressive correction would create unnecessary risk.
Previous Repairs	Repainted panels, body filler, blended areas and non-factory paint behavior.
Paint Hardness	Different manufacturers and paint systems respond differently to the same pad and compound.
Contamination	Overspray, tar, iron, mineral deposits and other bonded contamination that can interfere with correction.
Edges & Body Lines	High-risk areas where clear coat can be thinner and where excessive machine pressure can cause damage.
Previous Coatings / Films	Old ceramic coatings, sealants, PPF or vinyl that may need to be removed or handled separately.

5. IMPORTANT LIMITATIONS & WARNINGS

SOME PAINT IS TOO FAR GONE. Paint correction cannot safely restore every vehicle. Severely oxidized, peeling, cracking, delaminating, failing or extremely thin clear coat may be unsafe to compound or polish aggressively. We may recommend a limited enhancement, non-abrasive service, or repainting instead.

SOME SCRATCHES ARE TOO DEEP. If a scratch has penetrated through the clear coat into the color coat, primer, metal or another layer, polishing cannot safely remove it. Attempting to chase a deep scratch can remove excessive clear coat and create a much larger problem.

Rock chips, deep gouges, dents, rust, missing paint, severe etching, paint transfer, cracking clear coat and substrate damage may require repair rather than polishing.

Correction percentages are estimates, not guarantees. Results depend on paint hardness, defect depth, clear-coat thickness, previous repairs, tool/pad/compound combination, lighting, and how much correction can safely be performed.

6. SURFACE PREPARATION

1. Vehicle inspection and paint-condition assessment.
2. Exterior rinse to remove loose dirt and sand.
3. Foam / pre-soak to loosen traffic film and grime.
4. Thorough hand wash using safe wash media.
5. Wheels, tires and wheel wells cleaned separately.
6. Chemical decontamination as required.
7. Iron/fallout removal when needed.
8. Tar, sap and adhesive treatment when needed.
9. Clay decontamination when required for a smooth polishing surface.
10. Final rinse and thorough drying.
11. Crevice blow-out around trim, emblems, handles and body gaps.
12. Paint inspection under appropriate detailing lights before machine correction.

7. COMPOUND & POLISHING PROCESS

The exact process is selected after inspection. Pad choice, compound, polish, machine speed, pressure, working time and number of passes are adjusted to the paint system and defect level.

- Test spot first: A small section is corrected to establish the safest effective combination.
- Cutting stage: A compound and appropriate pad may be used to reduce defects where safe.
- Refinement stage: A finishing polish and pad may be used to improve clarity and remove haze or micro-marring left by the cutting process.
- Panel-by-panel inspection: Results are checked under proper lighting before continuing.
- Final wipe-down: Polishing oils and residue are removed before protection is applied.

8. ADDITIONAL SERVICES & CONDITIONS

Service / Condition	Starting / Additional Price
Heavy Contamination / Overspray Removal	+\$75–\$250
Heavy Water Spot Removal	+\$100–\$350
Old Coating / Sealant Stripping	\$60/hr
Paint Transfer Removal	+\$75–\$250
High-Spot / Previous Coating Leveling	+\$100–\$300
Extra Heavy Correction / Custom Process	Quote after inspection
Panel-Specific Correction	Quote after inspection
Repainted / Delicate Panel Work	Quote after inspection

9. VEHICLE ACCEPTANCE & CUSTOMER DISCLOSURES

- Final pricing is confirmed after an in-person inspection.
- Customers should disclose known repainting, bodywork, previous polishing, ceramic coatings, PPF, vinyl wrap, touch-up paint or other surface treatments.
- Vehicles with failing clear coat may be declined for aggressive correction.
- Paint correction does not guarantee 100% defect removal.
- The safest professional result may intentionally leave some deeper defects rather than removing excessive clear coat.
- Additional labor may be required if the vehicle arrives heavily contaminated or in substantially worse condition than represented in photos.

10. WHAT HAPPENS AFTER POLISHING?

PROTECTION SHOULD BE APPLIED AS SOON AS PRACTICAL. Once paint has been polished, the surface has been refined and the protection that will preserve that finish should be established promptly. Do not leave freshly corrected paint unprotected longer than necessary.

Polishing improves appearance, but polishing itself is not long-term paint protection. After correction, we strongly recommend applying a quality protectant such as a ceramic coating, paint sealant, or appropriate wax. A ceramic coating is the preferred long-term protection option when the customer wants stronger chemical resistance, UV protection, hydrophobic behavior, easier maintenance and longer-lasting gloss.

Protection also helps reduce the need for frequent aggressive polishing in the future by making the surface easier to maintain properly.

11. AFTERCARE

- Use a pH-neutral vehicle shampoo and safe wash media.
- Avoid automatic brush washes and abrasive wash methods.
- Use clean microfiber drying towels or forced air.
- Remove bird droppings, tree sap, bugs and other contaminants promptly, especially in tropical heat.
- Avoid harsh chemicals and abrasive products unless specifically intended for the protection system installed.
- Maintain the protective layer according to the manufacturer's recommendations.

12. CUSTOMER QUOTE WORKSHEET

Customer Name	_____
Customer Phone / Email	_____
Vehicle Year / Make / Model	_____
Paint Color / Type	_____
Paint Condition	Excellent / Good / Fair / Poor / Failing
Service Selected	Enhancement / One-Step / Stage 1 / Stage 2 / Custom
Estimated Correction	_____ %
Additional Prep / Decontamination	YES / NO — _____
Protection Selected After Polish	Ceramic / Sealant / Wax / Other
Estimated Completion Date	_____

PRICE SUMMARY

Item	Amount
Paint Correction Service	\$ _____
Additional Prep / Decontamination	\$ _____
Panel-Specific / Additional Labor	\$ _____
Paint Protection After Polish	\$ _____
TOTAL QUOTED PRICE	\$ _____

CUSTOMER APPROVAL

I have reviewed the selected paint correction services, limitations, preparation requirements, disclaimers and pricing. I understand that some defects may be too deep to safely remove and that paint condition can limit the amount of correction possible. I authorize Splash & Dash Auto Detail Center to perform the work described in this quote.

Customer Signature: _____ Date: _____

Splash & Dash Representative: _____ Date: _____

PRICING BASIS

Labor target: \$20/hour. Final pricing accounts for vehicle size, product and pad consumption, compound and polish usage, preparation, machine time, paint condition, correction difficulty, inspection time, cleanup, and risk. Heavy defect correction, oversized/custom vehicles and delicate or previously repaired paint are quoted individually.

SPLASH & DASH AUTO DETAIL CENTER

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